

Creating OpenMRS Modules

This article demonstrates how to build a basic OpenMRS 'hello-world' module using the OpenMRS module framework as the base—a simple page that will be only shown to users if they are logged in. The software pre-requisites are the NetBeans IDE and SVN. Experience with Java development, especially Spring and Hibernate, is required.

First, create a directory for the development work—I called mine *development*—and change to it using the `cd` command. Do an SVN checkout of the OpenMRS module framework with the following command:

```
svn checkout http://svn.openmrs.org/openmrs-modules/helloworld/
```

Now launch NetBeans. Use *File > Open Project*, browse to the *development* directory, select the *pom.xml* file, and click *Open*. Once the project is open, the sub-projects can be opened by expanding the project and opening the API and OMOD (right-click it and select *Open*). Let's assume your module name is *Hello World* and its ID is: *helloworld*.



Note: The module ID is a unique (among modules) string that can distinguish the module from others. The module name can be anything that best describes it.

Once you have decided on the module ID and name, it's time to change some of the project properties. In case you want to skip this step, you can apply a diff to the checked-out version of the code by downloading it from: <https://gist.github.com/3067580>. Otherwise, modify the properties in the following files, replacing *@module_id@* with the module ID and *@module_package@* with the module package name:

- *omod/src/main/resources/HelloWorld.hbm.xml*
- *omod/src/main/resources/messages.properties*
- *omod/src/main/resources/config.xml*
- *omod/src/main/resources/messages_es.properties*

- *omod/src/main/resources/messages_fr.properties*
 - *omod/src/main/resources/moduleApplicationContext.xml*
- Other metadata that needs to be modified in the file *omod/src/main/resources/config.xml* is shown below:

```
<id>helloworld</id>
<name>helloworld</name>
<version>1.0</version>
<package>org.openmrs.module.helloworld</package>
<author>Ben Wolfec</author>
<description>Basic OpenMRS Sample Module</description>
```

Basic functionality

Now, let's add some more basic functionality: when a user

